

Workplace Violence Prevention Training

Introduction

This Prevention plan is a critical part of maintaining a safe, respectful, and productive environment for everyone. This training is designed to help employees recognize early warning signs, understand potential risks, and respond appropriately to situations that could escalate into violence. It will also outline Archibald's, the Company policies, reporting procedures, and available resources to ensure concerns are addressed quickly and effectively. By increasing awareness and promoting a culture of accountability and respect, each employee plays an important role in preventing workplace violence and protecting the well-being of their colleagues.

Buddy System for Opening and Closing

- Have two employees present when opening or closing the facility.
- Check the surroundings for suspicious activity before unlocking the doors.
- Ensure all security cameras and alarms are functioning before opening.
- Lock the doors immediately after entering during opening hours and after the last customer leaves during closing hours.
- Conduct a walkthrough to ensure all customers and unauthorized personnel have left before closing/locking up.
- Never count cash or handle financial transactions in view of the public.
- Report any suspicious behavior or security concern to management or local authorities.

Cash Handling Prevention Measures

Limit Cash on Hand:

- Set a maximum cash limit on the register at any given time:
 - **Morning limit:** (\$600)
 - **After six (6) PM limit:** (\$400)
- Regularly transfer excess cash to a secure safe.
- Keep the cash register closed when not in use.
- By 8 PM, it operates with only one cash register.
- Vary the route and time of bank deposits to avoid predictability.
- Conceal cash deposit bags when transporting them to the bank.
- **Leave empty cash drawers open** to visibly show there is no cash inside, minimizing theft risk.

Security Measures:

- Ensure security cameras around cash registers, safes, and throughout the facility are always operational.
- Restrict facility access to unauthorized individuals:
 - Vendors and customers must have manager authorization.
 - Only authorized employees are allowed in restricted areas.
- In case of an emergency, dial 911 immediately.

Door Security Policy

- **No one should enter or open the back door** when someone knocks—**not even for deliveries**.
- All doors must remain closed at all times. Entry is not permitted, including for deliveries or vendors, without proper authorization.
- Employees should verify management before accepting deliveries or vendors.
- Keep all **doors always locked** and use security cameras to monitor access.
- Report any suspicious activity or unauthorized attempts to enter the premises.

Business Cash Handling and Violence Prevention Policy

Secure Cash Handling Process

- Train employees in proper cash handling procedures.
- Keep the **cash register closed** when not in use.
- Encourage electronic payments (credit cards).

Secure Cash Transfers

- Vary the **route and time** of bank deposits to prevent predictability.

Aggressive Customers

- Avoid arguing or escalating a confrontation. De-escalate **the situation** with calm, neutral language.
- Call **911** if a customer becomes physically violent or threatens staff or guests.
- Train staff on how to safely remove or refuse service to unruly customers.

Alcohol Service Violence Prevention Policy

Employee Training & Awareness

- All employees serving alcohol must complete responsible alcohol service training.
- Employees should monitor guests for signs of intoxication and cut off service when necessary.
- If a guest becomes aggressive, employees should remain calm and notify a manager.

Handling Intoxicated or Aggressive Customers

- Refuse service to any guest showing signs of extreme intoxication.
- Avoid arguing or escalating a confrontation—de-escalate the situation with calm, neutral language.
- Call 911 if a customer becomes physically violent or threatens staff or guests.
- Train staff on how to safely remove or refuse service to an unruly customer

Preventing Physical Altercation

- **No weapons or dangerous objects** are allowed inside the premises.
- All managers should conduct regular **patrols of the location**.
- Any physical fights should be **immediately reported to law enforcement** and documented in an incident report.

Emergency Response Protocol

- **Panic Buttons** or emergency alarms are installed near registers and behind the bar.
- Employees should be trained on how to **handle emergency situations** such as fights, robbery attempts, or disorderly conduct.
- A **designated manager** should be responsible for calling the police if needed.

Employee Accountability and Reporting

- Employees must follow all security and cash handling policies at all times.
- Any **theft, cash discrepancies, or suspicious activities** should be reported to management immediately.
- **Failure to comply** with these policies may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

Employee Response Procedure for Robbery and Criminal Acts

The purpose is to ensure the safety of employees, customers, and company property during a robbery or other criminal act by providing clear procedures and prohibiting employees from confronting violent individuals.

1. General Safety Guidelines

- Employee safety is the **top priority** in any criminal situation.
- Employees **must not** attempt to confront, apprehend, or engage with violent individuals.
- Cooperation with law enforcement and security personnel is essential.

2. Robbery Response Procedure

If a robbery occurs:

- **During the Robbery:**
 - **Stay calm**, avoid sudden movements or actions that may escalate the situation.
 - **Comply with the robber's demands**, do not argue or resist.
 - **Do not attempt to fight back or chase the suspect.**
 - **Do not press alarm buttons unless safe to do so.**
 - **Avoid eye contact** but try to observe details discreetly (height, clothing, tattoos, scars).
 - **Do not attempt to conceal or protect company assets** – personal safety is more important than money or property.
- **After the Robbery:**
 1. **Ensure safety first.** Check on yourself, coworkers, and customers.
 2. **Do not discuss details with coworkers or customers** until law enforcement arrives.
 3. **Call 911** as soon as it is safe. Provide:
 - Business name, address, and nature of the crime.
 - Description of the suspect(s) and vehicle (if applicable).
 - Direction of escape.
 4. **Follow management and law enforcement instructions.**
 5. **Write a report** of the incident as soon as possible for documentation.

3. Violent or Criminal Acts (Non-robbery) Response

If an individual is committing a violent act, vandalism, or threatening behavior:

- **Avoid direct confrontation.**
- **Stay at a safe distance and observe.**

- **Do not argue or escalate the situation.**
- **Notify a manager or security personnel immediately.**
- **If necessary, call 911** and provide details.

Employees (who are not security guards) are strictly prohibited from:

- Physically intervening in fights or violent acts.
- Restraining or attempting to detain a suspect.
- Chasing after fleeing suspects.
- Engaging in verbal altercations with a suspect.

4. Active Shooter or Armed Threat Response

If an individual is armed and threatening violence:

- **Run** – If it is safe to escape, do so immediately
- **Hide** – If escape is not possible, find a secure hiding place, lock doors, and stay silent.
- **Call 911** when safe to do so.
- **Do not engage** the armed individual.

5. Reporting & Post-Incident Procedure

- **All criminal incidents must be reported immediately** to management and law enforcement.
- **Employees must fully cooperate** with police investigations.
- **Employees who violate this policy by confronting a suspect** may face disciplinary action, including termination.

Customer Aggression Prevention Policy & Training Guide

Archibald's is committed to maintaining a safe, respectful, and harassment-free environment. Any form of aggression, abuse, or violence from customers or employees will not be tolerated. Employees will be trained to de-escalate tense situations and respond appropriately to customer aggression.

Understanding Customer Aggression

Customer aggression can take different forms, including:

- **Verbal aggression:** yelling, cursing, threats.
- **Physical aggression:** pushing, hitting, and throwing objects.
- **Passive aggression:** sarcasm, belittling, intimidation.
- **Online aggression:** negative reviews, social media threats.

Recognizing these signs early can help prevent escalation.

Prevention Strategies

- **Clear Communication:** Provide clear pricing, policies, and service expectations upfront to avoid misunderstandings.
- **Signage:** Display “Zero Tolerance for Abuse” signs in visible areas.
- **Customer Service Training:** Equip staff with conflict-resolution skills
- **Prompt Service:** Reduce frustration by ensuring efficient and timely service.
- **Calm Work Environment:** Keep the workplace clean, organized, and stress-free to help maintain a positive atmosphere.

De-Escalation Techniques

- **Remain Calm:** Avoid responding with anger or aggression.
- **Active Listening:** Let the customer express their frustration before responding.
- **Empathy & Acknowledgment:** Show understanding of their concerns.
- **Offer Solutions:** Provide alternative resolutions where possible.
- **Know When to End the Conversation:** If a customer continues to be aggressive despite de-escalation attempts, disengage and involve a supervisor.

Handling Violent or Threatening Situations

If a customer becomes violent or threatens harm:

- **Do not engage physically.**
- **Signal for help if needed**
- **Remove yourself from danger.**
- **Call law enforcement if the threat is serious.**
- **Document the incident for company records.**

Employees must not:

- Attempt to physically restrain an aggressive customer.
- Escalate the situation through argument or threats.
- Put themselves or others at unnecessary risk.

Employee Training Program

Employees will receive training on:

- Recognizing signs of aggression.
- De-escalation techniques.
- Conflict resolution strategies.
- Reporting and documenting incidents.

Incident Reporting and Documentation

Employees must report all incidents of aggression to a supervisor.

A formal **Incident Report Form** must be completed, detailing:

- Date, time, and location.
- Description of the event.
- Actions taken.
- Witness statements.

Reports will be reviewed to improve future prevention strategies.

Customers displaying aggressive behavior may be refused service or banned from the premises.

Employees who fail to follow de-escalation procedures or provoke customers may face disciplinary actions, including termination.

Commitment to a Safe Workplace

The Company is dedicated to providing a secure and respectful workplace for employees and customers. By implementing and enforcing these policies, we aim to:

- Prevent workplace violence and customer aggression.
- Protect employees from harm.
- Foster a professional and supportive work environment.

Workplace Violence Prevention Training Plan

Acknowledgement of Receipt and Review

I, _____, acknowledge that I received and read Archibald's Workplace Violence Prevention Training Plan, and understand that it is my responsibility to comply with its terms, as well as any future updates or revisions to the Plan. If I have any questions about this Plan, I will contact my direct manager, the General Manager, or the Chief Operating Officer.

Signature

Printed Name

Date

Training Sign-In Sheet

Training Topic: Workplace Violence Prevention Plan (WVPP)

Trainer Name: _____

Training Date: _____